**How the country's oldest airline stacks up against its largest rival in terms of fleet size, age and expansion plans**

## INDIGO

**AGE OF FLEET**

| Less than 10 years | More than 10 years |
|---|---|
| 94% | 6% |

**CURRENT FLEET: 408**

**AIRBUS: 360**
A320 (N): **220**
A321 (N): **140**

**ATR: 48**
72-600 (N): **48**

**NEW ORDERS: ~1,000#**

**AIRBUS: 629**
A320neo (N): **125** [2023-30]
A321neo (N): **375** [2024-35]
A321XLR (N): **69** [2026-29]
A350-900 (W): **60** [2027-35]

*#Other than those listed, includes option to buy 40 more A350s, plus 300 A320neo family aircraft ordered in 2019 (several deliveries pending), and 50 ATRs*

*(N): Narrowbody aircraft; (W): Widebody aircraft; Delivery schedule in []; Sources: MoCA & DGCA*

*Graphics by* TANMOY CHAKRABORTY

of strategic disinvestment, one of the big chapters of India's reforms era. It also cued an arrival of corporate efficiencies, borne aloft on the Tata Group's ambition to carve out a big stake in the aviation business.

It wasn't an easy task. The acquisition came at a price of Rs 18,000 crore, at a time when the national carrier—a dominant player in India's international and domestic sectors—was saddled with Rs 61,562 crore in debt and had reported losses

## A RICH LEGACY

**A brief history of Air India and the Tata Group's aviation ventures**




**1932:** Founded as Tata Airlines by J.R.D. Tata, nationalised in 1953

**2007:** Indian Airlines merged into Air India to create a single state-owned carrier



**2014:** Tatas re-enter aviation through a joint venture with Malaysia's AirAsia Berhad



**2015:** Vistara, the joint venture between Tatas and Singapore Airlines, starts operations

**2021-22:** The Tata Group buys Air India, along with low-cost Air India Express



**2022:** The Tatas take full control of AirAsia India, rename it AIX Connect, ahead of merger with Air India Express in October 2024

**2024:** Vistara merges with Air India in November. Tatas own 74.9 per cent in the merged entity, Singapore Airlines holds the rest

